



BIRD WATCHING JOURNAL

*Your Field Companion for
Birding Adventures & Discoveries*

LIFE LIST

SIGHTING LOG

FIELD NOTES

SKETCH PAGES

◉ EXPLORE. OBSERVE. RECORD. ◉

MORE SHINE PRESS



This Journal Belongs To

Fill in your details below

NAME

HOME LOCATION / REGION

FAVORITE BIRDING SPOT

FAVORITE BIRD SPECIES

YEAR STARTED BIRDING

How to Use This Journal

A quick guide to getting the most out of your birding adventures

1 Sighting Log

Record every bird you spot in the field. Note the species, date, location, weather, and behavior. Use the field marks section to describe identifying features.

2 Life List

Your running tally of every species you've ever identified. Check off each bird the first time you see it, and record the date and location of that exciting first sighting.

3 Trip Journal

Document your birding trips — where you went, who you were with, what conditions were like, and the highlights of your adventure.

4 Sketch Pages

Use the blank and lightly-lined pages to sketch birds you observe. Drawing helps you notice details and improves your identification skills.

5 Seasonal Guide

Track migration patterns and seasonal changes. Note when birds arrive in spring and depart in fall, and how behavior changes throughout the year.

◦ BIRDING ETHICS

Always respect wildlife and their habitats. Keep a respectful distance, never disturb nesting birds, and follow all local rules in parks and natural areas. Leave no trace — take only photos and memories.

My Birding Profile

Record your birding identity and goals

MY EXPERIENCE LEVEL

☐ Beginner ☐ Intermediate ☐ Advanced ☐ Expert

HOW I GOT STARTED BIRDING

MY BIRDING GEAR

Binoculars, field guide, camera, apps, etc.

MY FAVORITE PLACES TO BIRD

BIRDS I MOST HOPE TO SEE (BUCKET LIST)

MY GOALS FOR THIS YEAR

e.g., Identify 50 new species, visit 5 new birding spots, learn 20 bird songs

Habitat Quick Reference

Common birding habitats and species you might find there

Backyard / Feeder Songbirds, finches, sparrows, woodpeckers, hummingbirds
Deciduous Forest Warblers, thrushes, vireos, tanagers, owls
Coniferous Forest Crossbills, kinglets, nuthatches, grouse
Wetlands / Marsh Herons, egrets, ducks, rails, marsh wrens
Lakes & Ponds Grebes, loons, geese, swallows, kingfishers
Grasslands / Fields Meadowlarks, bobolinks, hawks, sparrows
Coast / Shoreline Gulls, terns, sandpipers, plovers, pelicans
Urban / City Parks Pigeons, doves, starlings, crows, raptors
◦ TIP Different habitats attract different species. Visit a variety of habitats throughout the year to maximize the number of species on your life list!

Seasonal Birding Guide

What to expect and watch for each season

Spring (Mar-May)

Migration season! Warblers, thrushes, and flycatchers return. Courtship displays, territorial singing, and nest building begin. Peak time for diversity.

Summer (Jun-Aug)

Breeding season. Fledglings are everywhere. Look for nesting behavior and juvenile plumages. Shorebirds begin southbound migration in late summer.

Fall (Sep-Nov)

Southbound migration. Hawks, eagles, and falcons soar overhead. Sparrows and waterfowl arrive. Confusing fall plumages challenge identification skills.

Winter (Dec-Feb)

Year-round residents plus northern visitors. Owls, hawks, finches, and sparrows. Feeder activity peaks. Great time for waterfowl and raptor watching.

MY SEASONAL NOTES

Record what you notice about birds in each season where you live

SPRING	SUMMER
FALL	WINTER

Bird Identification Tips

Key features to look for when identifying birds

THE FIVE KEYS TO IDENTIFICATION

1 Size & Shape

Compare to familiar birds. Is it sparrow-sized? Robin-sized? Crow-sized? Note the silhouette — body shape, bill, tail, and wings.

2 Color Pattern

Note overall color, but also look for specific markings: wing bars, eye rings, caps, bibs, streaks, and patches. Remember: light matters!

3 Behavior

How does it move? Does it tail-bob, wing-flick, or hover? Does it walk, hop, or climb? Is it alone or in a flock? What is it eating?

4 Habitat

Where are you? Forest, field, wetland, or shore? Habitat narrows down possibilities dramatically.

5 Voice

Songs and calls are often the best clue. Learn common bird sounds. Note rhythm, pitch, and quality.

FIELD MARKS TO NOTE

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Bill shape & color | ☐ Eye color / eye ring |
| ☐ Head pattern / cap | ☐ Wing bars / patches |
| ☐ Tail shape / pattern | ☐ Leg & foot color |
| ☐ Underpart streaks | ☐ Rump / vent color |

◦ REMEMBER

Lighting, distance, and season can all affect how a bird looks. Don't rely on just one feature — use a combination of clues for confident identification.

Month-by-Month Guide

What to watch for throughout the year

January	Winter residents at feeders. Look for owls, hawks, winter finches, waterfowl.
February	Owls begin nesting. Early spring songs. Duck migration begins.
March	Early migrants arrive. Red-winged blackbirds, robins, killdeer. Woodpeckers drumming.
April	Peak migration begins. Warblers, swallows, thrushes return. Courtship displays.
May	Peak warbler migration! Flycatchers, vireos, tanagers arrive. Shorebird migration.
June	Breeding season peak. Baby birds everywhere. Nesting activity. Song at maximum.
July	Shorebirds begin southbound migration. Young birds learning to feed. Quiet post-breeding.
August	Fall migration ramps up. Warblers in fall plumage. Hummingbirds heading south.
September	Hawk migration peaks. Broad-winged hawks in kettles. Nighthawks and swifts moving.
October	Sparrow migration. Waterfowl arriving. Late warblers. Kinglets and creepers.
November	Waterfowl peak. Late hawks. Northern finches may arrive. Winter residents settling in.
December	Christmas Bird Count season! Winter residents established. Owl prowls. Feeder birds.

01

PART ONE

Sighting Log

Record every bird you observe in the field

Sighting Log

Record your observations in the field

Date	Time	Species	#	Location

WEATHER

☐ Sunny ☐ Cloudy ☐ Rainy ☐ Foggy

Temp: _____ Wind: _____

HABITAT

☐ Forest ☐ Wetland ☐ Field

☐ Backyard ☐ Shore ☐ Urban

BEHAVIOR & ACTIVITY NOTES

feeding, singing, flying, nesting, perching, etc.

Species:

Species:

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Species:

☐ First sighting (life bird!) ☐ Photo taken ☐ Audio recorded ☐ Heard only

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Species: _____

Species: _____

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FIELD NOTES & OBSERVATIONS

02

PART TWO

Life List

Your running tally of every species identified

Life List

Check off each species the first time you identify it

#	Species Name	Date First Seen	Location	✓
1				☐
2				☐
3				☐
4				☐
5				☐
6				☐
7				☐
8				☐
9				☐
10				☐
11				☐
12				☐
13				☐
14				☐
15				☐
16				☐
17				☐
18				☐
19				☐
20				☐

Life List (cont. 2)

Check off each species the first time you identify it

#	Species Name	Date First Seen	Location	✓
21				☐
22				☐
23				☐
24				☐
25				☐
26				☐
27				☐
28				☐
29				☐
30				☐
31				☐
32				☐
33				☐
34				☐
35				☐
36				☐
37				☐
38				☐
39				☐
40				☐

Life List (cont. 3)

Check off each species the first time you identify it

#	Species Name	Date First Seen	Location	✓
41				☐
42				☐
43				☐
44				☐
45				☐
46				☐
47				☐
48				☐
49				☐
50				☐
51				☐
52				☐
53				☐
54				☐
55				☐
56				☐
57				☐
58				☐
59				☐
60				☐

Life List (cont. 4)

Check off each species the first time you identify it

#	Species Name	Date First Seen	Location	✓
61				☐
62				☐
63				☐
64				☐
65				☐
66				☐
67				☐
68				☐
69				☐
70				☐
71				☐
72				☐
73				☐
74				☐
75				☐
76				☐
77				☐
78				☐
79				☐
80				☐

Life List (cont. 5)

Check off each species the first time you identify it

#	Species Name	Date First Seen	Location	✓
81				☐
82				☐
83				☐
84				☐
85				☐
86				☐
87				☐
88				☐
89				☐
90				☐
91				☐
92				☐
93				☐
94				☐
95				☐
96				☐
97				☐
98				☐
99				☐
100				☐

Life List (cont. 6)

Check off each species the first time you identify it

#	Species Name	Date First Seen	Location	✓
101				☐
102				☐
103				☐
104				☐
105				☐
106				☐
107				☐
108				☐
109				☐
110				☐
111				☐
112				☐
113				☐
114				☐
115				☐
116				☐
117				☐
118				☐
119				☐
120				☐

03

PART THREE

Trip Journal

Document your birding adventures and travels

Birding Trip Journal

Document your birding adventures

Date: _____ Start Time: _____ End: _____

LOCATION / SITE NAME

COMPANIONS

WEATHER CONDITIONS

Sky: _____ Temp: _____ Wind: _____

SPECIES OBSERVED list each species and count

Species	Count	Notes

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS & MEMORABLE MOMENTS

TOTAL SPECIES COUNT

FIELD NOTES & OBSERVATIONS

☐ Life bird seen ☐ Photos taken ☐ First visit to this site ☐ Would return

Birding Trip Journal

Document your birding adventures

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TRIP HIGHLIGHTS & MEMORABLE MOMENTS

TOTAL SPECIES COUNT

FIELD NOTES & OBSERVATIONS

☐ Life bird seen ☐ Photos taken ☐ First visit to this site ☐ Would return

Birding Trip Journal

Document your birding adventures

Date: _____ Start Time: _____ End: _____

LOCATION / SITE NAME

COMPANIONS

WEATHER CONDITIONS

Sky: _____ Temp: _____ Wind: _____

SPECIES OBSERVED list each species and count

Species	Count	Notes

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04

PART FOUR

Backyard Bird Watch

Track the feathered visitors to your yard and feeders

Backyard Bird Watch Log

Track the birds that visit your yard and feeders

Date:

Season:

WEATHER

☐ Sunny ☐ Cloudy ☐ Rainy ☐ Snowy Temp:

FEEDER TYPES IN USE

☐ Tube feeder ☐ Hopper ☐ Suet ☐ Nyjer/thistle ☐ Hummingbird ☐ Ground/tray

VISITOR LOG

species & how many at once

Species	Max Count	Behavior / Food

OBSERVATIONS & NOTES

Interactions, dominance, new visitors, nesting activity, etc.

☐ New yard bird! ☐ Predator seen (hawk/cat) ☐ Refilled feeder today

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05

PART FIVE

Migration Tracker

Record the rhythms of bird movement through the year

Migration Tracker

Record arrival and departure dates for migrating species

SPRING ARRIVAL DATES

When do migrants first appear in your area each spring?

Species	First Seen	Last Year	Notes

FALL DEPARTURE DATES

When do migrants leave your area each fall?

Species	Last Seen	Last Year	Notes

MIGRATION NOTES & PATTERNS

Migration Tracker

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When do migrants leave your area each fall?

Species	Last Seen	Last Year	Notes

MIGRATION NOTES & PATTERNS

06

PART SIX

Field Sketches

Draw and describe the birds you encounter

Field Sketch

Draw what you see — notes help you remember

SPECIES

DATE & LOCATION

SIZE / COLOR

FIELD MARKS & DESCRIPTION

beak, plumage, behavior, distinctive features

Field Sketch

Draw what you see — notes help you remember

SPECIES

DATE & LOCATION

SIZE / COLOR

FIELD MARKS & DESCRIPTION

beak, plumage, behavior, distinctive features

Field Sketch

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SPECIES

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SPECIES

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SPECIES

DATE & LOCATION

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beak, plumage, behavior, distinctive features

07

PART SEVEN

Year in Review & Notes

Reflect on your birding journey and record your thoughts

My Birding Year in Review

Reflect on your birding adventures this year

Year: _____

TOTAL SPECIES IDENTIFIED THIS YEAR

TOTAL BIRDING TRIPS

NEW LIFE BIRDS THIS YEAR

Added _____ species to my life list!

BEST BIRDING MOMENT OF THE YEAR

BEST NEW BIRD (MY FAVORITE DISCOVERY)

NEW PLACES I WENT BIRDING

WHAT I LEARNED THIS YEAR

GOALS FOR NEXT YEAR

My Birding Year in Review

Reflect on your birding adventures this year

Year: _____

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TOTAL BIRDING TRIPS

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BEST NEW BIRD (MY FAVORITE DISCOVERY)

NEW PLACES I WENT BIRDING

WHAT I LEARNED THIS YEAR

GOALS FOR NEXT YEAR

Field Notes

Lined area for field notes.

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◉ A Perfect Gift for Nature Lovers ◉

Whether you're a seasoned birder or just discovering the joy of birdwatching, this journal is your companion for every adventure.

- Keep a running life list of every species you see
- Log detailed sighting records with location and weather
- Track birds by season, habitat, and behavior
- Sketch and describe your feathered discoveries
- Plan birding trips and record your adventures
- Reflect on the beauty of nature all year long

Every bird tells a story. Start recording yours!

MORE SHINE PRESS